

closure_evidence_20260923

BOB-213 closure evidence — 2026-09-23

Defect

constitution/scripts/gates/
cm_dangerous_combination_fail_closed.sh's default extension list
omitted sh/bash entirely — 198 tracked .sh files project-wide, including
71 of 74 source files in the scripts/ DANGER_ROOT directly, were
invisible to the §11.4.252 fail-closed gate.

Fix

- DANGEROUS_COMBO_EXT default extended: ... php rb sh bash (line 603).
- Shell-native credential-default-to-literal detector added (parameter expansion \${TOKEN:-literal} shape), matching the existing Python/JS/Go detectors' semantics. The shell try/catch-block counterpart (shape A) is explicitly, honestly declined — shell has no fixed block syntax to key on for that shape; documented in-source (lines 480-489) rather than silently assumed covered, per §11.4.6.

Independent verification (coordinator, from clean shell)

```
$ grep -n "DANGEROUS_COMBO_EXT" constitution/scripts/gates/  
cm_dangerous_combination_fail_closed.sh  
603:exts="${DANGEROUS_COMBO_EXT:-py go rs c cc cpp h hpp java cs  
js ts jsx tsx php rb sh bash}"
```

Confirmed sh bash present in the default list.

```
$ bash constitution/scripts/gates/  
cm_dangerous_combination_fail_closed_mutation_test.sh  
...  
  META OK:   L67 shell credential silently defaulted to a literal  
via parameter expansion (BOB-213) – gate correctly FAILED on the  
mutation (rc=1)  
  META OK:   L67 (degraded text-fallback mode) – gate correctly  
FAILED on the mutation (rc=1)  
  META OK:   L68 NEGATIVE CONTROL – shell credential fallback to  
ANOTHER VARIABLE is legitimate (BOB-213) – gate correctly PASSED  
on clean fixture  
  META OK:   L69 NEGATIVE CONTROL – shell credential fallback to  
COMMAND SUBSTITUTION is legitimate (BOB-213) – gate correctly  
PASSED on clean fixture  
  META OK:   L70 pre-existing credential-default-to-literal  
shape, now DISCOVERABLE in a .sh file (BOB-213 extension-list fix)  
– gate correctly FAILED on the mutation (rc=1)  
...  
  META PASS – CM-DANGEROUS-COMBINATION-FAIL-CLOSED FAILs-on-  
mutation AND PASSes-on-clean for every fixture ($1.1 proof holds)  
META_EXIT=0
```

Full suite re-run independently by the coordinator (not trusted from the subagent's report alone) — 165 META OK, 0 META FAIL, exit 0.

Honest boundary disclosed

No shell-native counterpart for the try/catch-block swallowed-exception shape (shape A) — shell has no decidable block syntax to key on for this, same reasoning the gate already applies to declining unreliable cross-statement heuristics elsewhere. Documented in-source, not silently assumed covered.

Status

Fixed. Closed by coordinator after independent re-verification.